



US00PP31294P3

(12) **United States Plant Patent**
Larse

(10) **Patent No.:** **US PP31,294 P3**
(45) **Date of Patent:** **Dec. 31, 2019**

(54) **STRAWBERRY PLANT NAMED ‘ALICIA’**

(50) Latin Name: *Fragaria x ananassa*
Varietal Denomination: **Alicia (a.k.a. ‘109180’)**

(71) Applicant: **SWEET DARLING SALES, INC.,**
Aptos, CA (US)

(72) Inventor: **John Larse**, Watsonville, CA (US)

(73) Assignee: **Sweet Darling Sales, Inc.**, Aptos, CA (US)

(*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this patent is extended or adjusted under 35 U.S.C. 154(b) by 0 days.

(21) Appl. No.: **15/932,838**

(22) Filed: **May 4, 2018**

(65) **Prior Publication Data**
US 2018/0324992 P1 Nov. 8, 2018

Related U.S. Application Data

(60) Provisional application No. 62/501,253, filed on May 4, 2017.

(51) **Int. Cl.**
A01H 5/08 (2018.01)
A01H 6/74 (2018.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
USPC **Plt./208**
CPC *A01H 6/7409* (2018.05)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**
USPC Plt./208, 209
CPC A01H 5/0893
See application file for complete search history.

(56) **References Cited**

PUBLICATIONS

<https://www.alamy.com/stock-photo-strawberry-fragaria-alice-growing-in-a-clay-terracotta-pot-80317457.html>; Jun. 29, 2012; 1 page*
GTITM UPOVROM Citation For ‘Alice’ as per QZ PBR 20000098; Apr. 14, 2000; 1 page.*

* cited by examiner

Primary Examiner — Kent L Bell
(74) *Attorney, Agent, or Firm* — Cooley LLP

(57) **ABSTRACT**

The present invention provides new and distinct strawberry plant designated as ‘Alicia’ (a.k.a. ‘109180’).

6 Drawing Sheets

1

Latin name of the genus and species: *Fragaria x ananassa*.
Varietal denomination: ‘Alicia’ (a.k.a. ‘109180’).

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to new and distinct strawberry plant designated as ‘Alicia’ (a.k.a. ‘109180’). ‘Alicia’ (a.k.a. ‘109180’) is the result of a controlled-cross made on May 29, 2013 between a female parent cultivar designated 105218 (a.k.a., ‘Zaralina’) and a male parent cultivar designated 102850 (a.k.a., ‘Victor’) made by the Inventor and was first fruited in Watsonville, Calif. growing fields. Following selection and during testing, the plant was originally designated ‘109180’ and subsequently named ‘Alicia’. ‘Alicia’ is a day-neutral plant.

This new strawberry plant was asexually reproduced via runners (stolons) by the inventor at Watsonville, Calif. Asexual propagules from the original source have been tested in Watsonville growing fields and to a limited extent, grower fields in high elevation. The properties of this plant were found to be transmissible by such asexual reproduction. The plant is stable and reproduces true to type in successive generations of asexual reproduction.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

This invention relates to new and distinctive strawberry plant designated as ‘Alicia’ (a.k.a. ‘109180’). The plant is primarily adapted to the climate and growing conditions of the central coast of California. This region provides the

2

necessary temperatures required for it to produce a strong vigorous plant and to remain in fruit production from March through October. The nearby Pacific Ocean provides the needed humidity and moderate day temperatures and evening chilling to maintain fruit quality for the production months.

‘Alicia’ has not been observed under all possible environmental conditions, and the phenotype may vary significantly with variations in environment, however with no variance in genotype. The following observations, measurements, and comparisons describe this plant as grown under normal conditions in Watsonville, Calif. unless otherwise noted.

The following traits and photographs in combination distinguish strawberry plant ‘Alicia’ from known strawberry plants. Plants for the botanical measurements in the present application were grown as annuals. Any color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, 1995 Edition, except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used. The plants were 8-month old when the observation was made.

TABLE 1		
‘Alicia’ Characteristics		
	Characteristic	Description
General	Plant Habit	Perennial
	Plant Growth Habit	Upright
	Day Length	Day Neutral

TABLE 1-continued

‘Alicia’ Characteristics		
Characteristic	Description	
Leaf	Height (cm)	34
	Width (cm)	35
	Density of foliage	low
	Plant vigor	moderate
	Crown Diameter	4 cm
	Fertility	Self-fertile
	Freezing quality	moderate
	Leaf shape	Concave
	Leaf variegation	Absent
	Leaflets per leaf	3
	Number of leaflets	88 to 128
	Terminal leaflet width (mm)	93
	Terminal leaflet length (mm)	86
	Terminal leaflet length/width ratio	1.08
	No. teeth/terminal leaflet	24
	Shape of terminal leaflet	Orbicular
	Shape of the terminal leaflet apex	Rounded
	Shape of the terminal leaflet base	acute
	Shape of terminal leaflet in cross-section	concave
	Margin description of the terminal	serrate to crenate
	Color of upper side of leaves	RHS 137A
	Color of lower side of leaves	RHS 139C
	Terminal leaflet margin	revolute
	Leaf blistering	weak
	Leaf glossiness	medium
Limbs	Petiole length (cm)	20
	Petiole diameter (mm)	4.8
	Petiole color	RHS 145A
	Petiolule length (cm)	0.95
	Petiolule diameter (mm)	3.83
	Petiolule color	RHS 145B
	Stipule length (cm)	4
	Stipule width (cm)	1.4
	Stipule pubescence	sparse
	Stipule anthocyanin	Present
	Stipule color (color code)	RHS 145C
	Stipule anthocyanin color	RHS 185B
	Pedicel color (color code)	145A
	Attitude of hairs on petiole and pedicel	upwards
	Inflorescence position relative to foliage	above
Inflorescence	flower arrangement of petals	free
	Petal length (cm)	1
	Peduncle length	16 cm
	Peduncle diameter	4.54 mm
	Peduncle color (color code)	RHS 145A
	Peduncle pubescence	Medium to dense
	Attitude of hairs on peduncle and pedicel	upwards
	Inflorescence position relative to foliage	Above
	Number of Flowers	22 to 38
	Flower arrangement of petals	free
	Petal length	1.0
	Petal width (cm)	1.1
	Petal length/width ratio	0.91
	Petal number per flower	5 to 6
	Upper Petal color	RHS 155C
	Lower Petal color	RHS 155D
	Petal shape	Orbicular
	Petal apex	rounded
	Petal base shape	concave
	peduncle size	medium
	Calyx diameter (cm)	3.7
	Calyx diameter relative to corolla	larger
	Inner calyx diameter relative to outer calyx	Smaller to equal
	Sepal number per flower	10 to 14
	Sepal length (cm)	1.3
	Sepal width (cm)	0.5

TABLE 1-continued

‘Alicia’ Characteristics	
Characteristic	Description
Sepal shape	Elliptical
Sepal apex	Convex
Sepal margin	Entire
Corolla diameter (cm)	2.6
Sepal length (cm)	1.3
Sepal width (cm)	0.5
Time of flowering (50% of plants in bloom)	March
Shape of stigma	capitate
Color of stigma	RHS 172A
Length of style (mm)	1.12
Color of style	RHS 6A
Color of the ovary	RHS 145B
Receptacle color	RHS 145A
Length of the stamens (mm)	4.6
Anther diameter (mm)	0.8
Anther length (mm)	1.2
Number of stamen	26
Shape of anther	dorsifixed
Size of anther	medium
Color of anther	RHS 12A
Amount of pollen	moderate to high
Color of pollen	RHS 22A
Color of filament	RHS 149D
Length of filament (mm)	2.73
Number of flowers per truss	3 to 6
Stolon number	3 to 11
Stolon anthocyanin	RHS 181A
Widest diameter of stolon	3.3
At leaf attachment (mm)	
Stolon color	RHS 145A
Stolon Length	52.67 cm
Stolon anthocyanin	RHS 181A
Stolon thickness	medium
Stolon pubescence	medium
Widest diameter of stolon at leaf attachment	3.3 mm
Number of fruit per truss	3 to 5
Fruit length (cm)	4.7
Fruit width (cm)	4.1
Fruit length/width ratio	1.15
Relative fruit size	medium
Fruit calyx diameter (cm)	5.2
Fruit skin color	RHS 45A
Fruit flesh color excluding core	RHS 41A
Fruit core color	RHS 49A
Color of calyx	RHS 137C
Position of calyx	Below surface
Level of adherence of calyx	strong
Pose of calyx segments	reflexed
Size of calyx in relation to fruit	Equal to larger
Fruit weight (g)	28
Predominant fruit shape	globose conic
Shape difference between primary & secondary fruits	No shape difference
Width of band without of achenes	medium
Fruit glossiness	medium
Position of achenes	even
Achene color	RHS 149A
Achenes per fruit	308
Achene weight (g)	0.22
Position of achenes in relation to skin surface	even
Surface texture	Smooth
Texture when tasted	medium
Position of calyx	inserted
Level of adherence of calyx	strong
Color of calyx	RHS 137C
Firmness of flesh	firm
Evenness of flesh color	nearly even
Sweetness Brix	8
Type of bearing	Day neutral
Time of fruit ripening	May

TABLE 1-continued

'Alicia' Characteristics	
Characteristic	Description
Harvest maturity (50% of plants with ripe fruit)	June
Appearance score (1 to 5 with 5 = best)	3.5
Storage longevity	5 to 10 days
pH	3.46
Yield (grams per plant per season)	2206
Hollow core length (cm)	1.9
Hollow core width (cm)	1.1
Hollow core length/width ratio	1.73
Hollow core size	medium

'Alicia' is distinguished from its paternal parent by its larger fruit size, greater ease of harvest, and its presentation of shorter and thicker petioles. 'Alicia' is distinguished from its maternal parent by its larger fruit size, greater yield volume, and longer flower stems. 'Alicia' is similar to the variety 'Monterey' (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 19,767), but possesses several distinguishing traits from Monterey. 'Alicia' is distinguished from 'Monterey' by its greater ease of harvest, smaller plant size, and higher berry yield per plant. 'Alicia' presents shorter and thicker petioles than 'Monterey'. 'Alicia' has a lower cull rate than 'Monterey' and both of its parents. 'Albion' (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 16,228) is a commercial strawberry variety that is similar to, but distinguished from 'Alicia'. The fruit yield of 'Alicia' exceeds the yield of 'Albion' in multiple annual testing cycles performed at the breeders test location in Watsonville Calif.

In addition, 'Alicia' scored better than it's parents for percent marketable fruit of the sum of all fruit produced in Watsonville Calif. test plots. Compared to its parents, 'Alicia' was observed to withstand adverse post harvest ambient temperatures over several days, demonstrating a putative

longer shelf life as well as less susceptibility to the discoloration effect associated with bruising that occurs during the hand harvesting procedure. The fruit of each of the parents of the strawberry plant variety named 'Alicia' was observed to be lighter in redness coloration 'Alicia'. One parent of 'Alicia', a strawberry plant variety named 'Victor' (a.k.a., 102850), was determined to be a short day variety, whereas 'Alicia' has been determined to be a day neutral type when grown in the breeder's Watsonville Calif. test farm. The color of the foliage of 'Victor' is a lighter green than it's offspring 'Alicia'. 'Victor' produces more fruit over the fruiting season than it's offspring 'Alicia', however 'Alicia' produces fruit during a longer period of time than it's short-day parent 'Victor'. The other parent of 'Alicia', a strawberry plant variety named 'Zaralina' (a.k.a., 105218) produces much less fruit than 'Alicia', and the plant structure of 'Zaralina' is smaller and more compact than 'Alicia'. The strawberry plant variety named 'Alicia' produces more stolon in the fruiting field than either of it's parents when grown in the breeder's Watsonville location.

DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

The accompanying color photographs depict various characteristics of the cultivars as nearly true as possible to make color reproductions.

FIG. 1 shows ripe and near-ripe fruits of 'Alicia' about 6-month old.

FIG. 2 shows 'Alicia' plants growing in the field with multiple fruits.

FIG. 3 shows the front side of a leaf of 'Alicia' plants.

FIG. 4 shows the back side of a leaf of 'Alicia' plants.

FIG. 5 shows fruits of 'Alicia' plants.

FIG. 6 shows fruits of 'Alicia' plants cut in half.

The invention claimed is:

1. A new and distinct cultivar of strawberry plant named 'Alicia', substantially as shown and described herein.

* * * * *



Figure 1



Figure 2

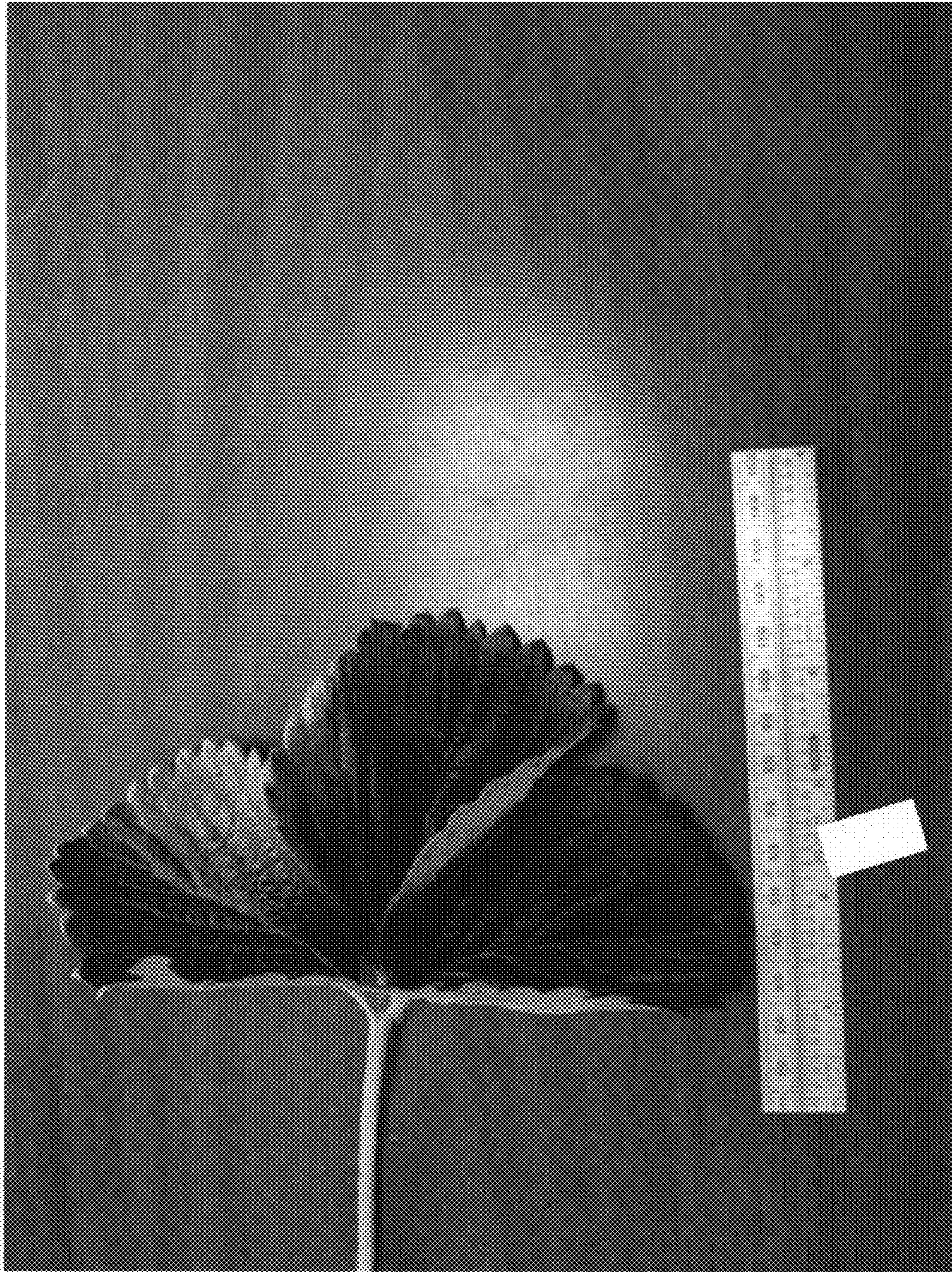


Figure 3

Figure 4

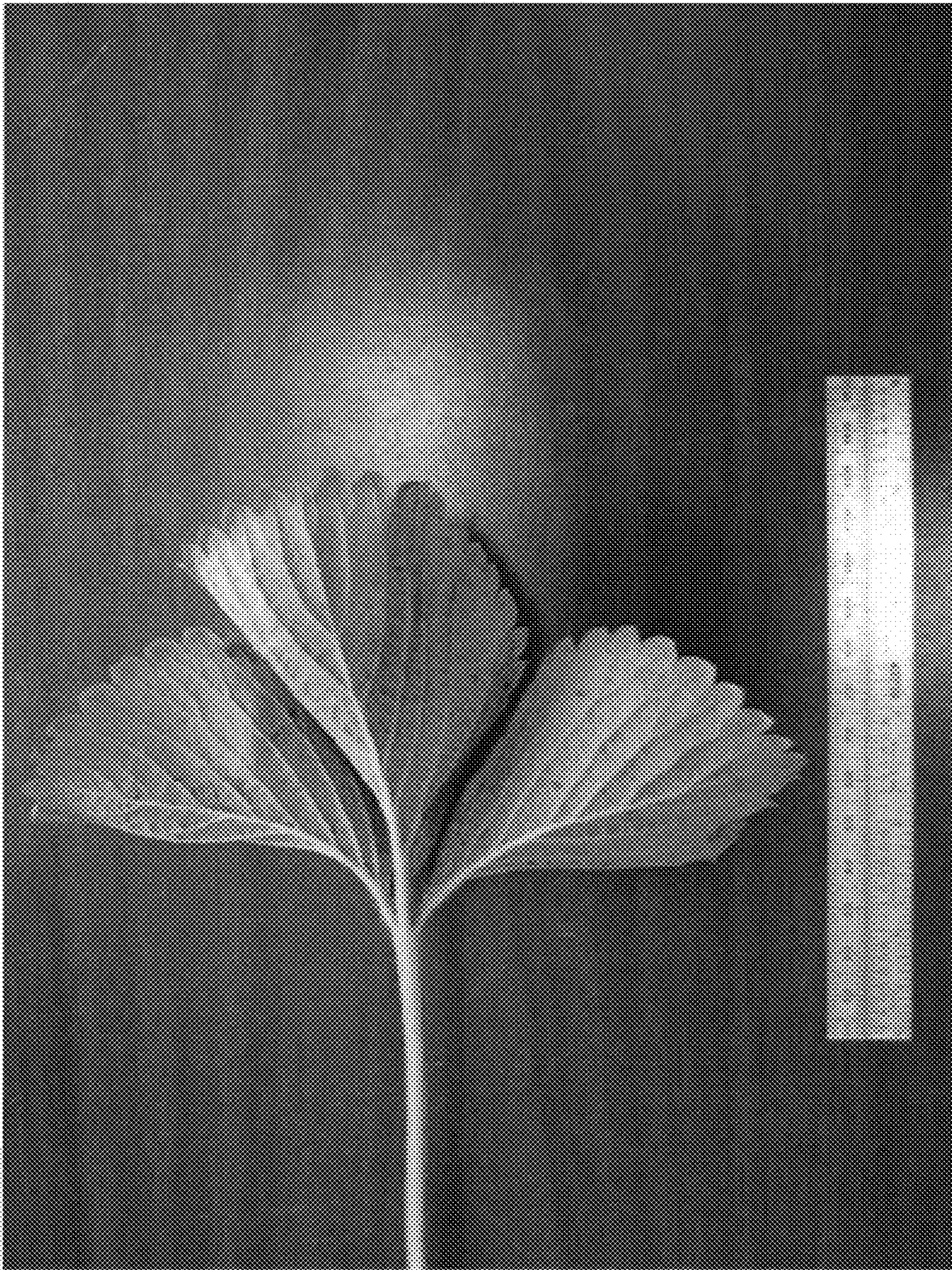




Figure 5



Figure 6